

A9

The A9 is a 64 bit system on chip which was used in the iPhone 6S and 6S Plus. Launched in 2015, it gave a tight competition to the Snapdragon 820 and Samsung Exynos 8890. The SoC featured an ARMv8-A based dual core CPUs clocked at 1.85 GHz codenamed twister. It also featured an updated image processor and an embedded motion coprocessor that services the accelerometer, gyroscope, compass and barometer.

Primary CPU	Twister @ 1.9GHz
CPU architecture	ARM big.LITTLE
CPU structure	RISC
DSP type	-
GPU	PowerVR 7XT GT7600
Year Released	2015
Devices	iphone 6S, iphone SE

Wrapping up

Qualcomm, Samsung, MediaTek and Huawei are the market leaders currently with Intel out of the race. If you compare their top of the line SoCs, and take a look at the specs on paper, you'll realize that they are almost similar. Even in the real world, almost all the SoCs fare closely, leading in some department while lagging in another.

Technology is advancing every day and these companies will continue to innovate with faster and more power efficient processors. Phones using the latest generation of SoCs (Snapdragon 835 vs Helio X30 vs Exynos 9 Octa 8895 vs Apple A10 Fusion Core) fabricated using 10nm process, are still scarce in the market. There is no clear winner in this race, not now at least, and we have to wait for phones that can fully exploit the potential of these state of the art SoCs. **d**